Updated: October 2026

JINGYU ZHANG

Robert H. Smith School of Business, University of Maryland
7621 Mowatt Ln, College Park, MD 20742
+1 (872) 904-3688 | jingyuz@umd.edu | jingyuzhang.org | SSRN

EDUCATION

University of Maryland 2027 *(expected)*
Ph.D. in Accounting

University of Chicago 2023, 2017
MBA, M.S. in Computer Science

The Chinese University of Hong Kong 2014
M.S. in Finance

Wuhan University 2013
B.S. in Economics, B.S. in Computer Science

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Financial Accounting, Auditing, and Entrepreneurship, with a focus on labor markets in startups and private firms

WORKING PAPERS

[1] **Patient Capital, Impatient Reporting: How Accounting Standards Reach the Startup Economy** [link]

- Solo-Authored Job Market Paper
- R&R at *The Accounting Review*
- Best Paper Award: 2026 Rutgers Accounting Doctoral Symposium (RADS)
- *Presentation*: Georgetown University (Scheduled), 2026 Rutgers Accounting Doctoral Symposium, University of Maryland

[2] **Not Just for Employers: LinkedIn Resume Revisions and Future Firm Performance** [link]

- With *Rebecca N. Hann* and *Mark Zakota*
- Under review
- Awarded the 2025 Smith Internal Research Grant (SIRG) ($10,000), University of Maryland
- *Presentation*: 2026 AAA Global Connect, University of Hong Kong*, University of Maryland*
- *Media Coverage*: Justina's Quant Newsletter

[3] **Early Promotion and Audit Quality: Evidence from Audit Office Promotion Practices** [link]

- With *Inna Abramova*, *Rebecca N. Hann*, and *Wenfeng Wang*
- Preparing for submission
- *Presentation*: 2026 Midyear Meeting of the Financial Accounting and Reporting Section (FARS), Boston University*, Fordham University*, London Business School*, MIT*, University of Miami*, University of Toronto*, Southern University of Science and Technology*, Renmin University of China*, 2025 AAA Annual Conference, Columbia Junior Accounting Conference*, NC State Risk Governance Research Symposium, the 2025 International Symposium on Audit Research*, the 2025 UBCOW Conference*, and USC Mini-Conference*

*Presentation by co-authors.

[4] **Private Equity and Audit Firm Strategy: Evidence from Public and Private Clients in the UK**

- With *Inna Abramova*, *Philip G. Berger*, and *Rebecca N. Hann*
- Awarded the 2025 Institute of Entrepreneurship and Private Capital Research Grant (£5,400), London Business School
- *Presentation*: University of Illinois 27th Symposium on Auditing Research*

[5] **Growing Leaner, Not Simpler: Generative AI and the Organization of Scaling Startups**

- With *Philip G. Berger*, *Rebecca N. Hann*, and *Kristen Valentine*
- Awarded the Polsky Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation Research Grant ($10,000), University of Chicago
- *Presentation*: 2026 Labor & Finance Conference* (Scheduled), National University of Singapore*, Fordham University*

[6] **Corporate Gadflies' ESG Activism**

- Solo-authored
- *Presentation*: Chicago Booth Accounting Workshop

Works in Progress

[7] **What Does the Silence Say?**

- With *Yvonne Han* and *Anastasia A. Zakolyukina*

[8] **CEO Personality and Bad Corporate Governance Outcomes**

- With *David Larcker* and *Anastasia A. Zakolyukina*

Conference Participation

[P] Presenter [R] Reviewer [D] Discussant [M] Moderator

2027 FARS Midyear Meeting[R×3]	2027
2027 Auditing Section Midyear Meeting[R×2]	2027
2026 AAA Global Doctoral Student Consortium, 2026 AAA Global Connect[P]	2026
Rutgers Accounting Doctoral Symposium[P]	2026
FASB Doctoral Student Program	2026
2026 Accounting Horizons Conference	2026
2026 CAAA Conference[R]	2026
2026 FARS Midyear Meeting[P,M]	2026
Annual Forum on Financial Information Systems and Cybersecurity	2025, 2026
American Accounting Association (AAA) Annual Meeting[P,R,D]	2024, 2025
2025 FARS Midyear Meeting, 2025 FARS Doctoral Consortium	2025
NC State Risk Governance Research Symposium[P]	2025
The Washington Accounting Research Symposium	2024
Becker Friedman Institute Corporate Governance Conference	2023
Journal of Accounting Research Conference	2020 – 2023

Selected Honors, Awards & Grants

Best Paper Award, Rutgers Accounting Doctoral Symposium (RADS)	2026
Long Jiang Graduate Student Fellowship, University of Maryland	2026
AAA Excellence in Reviewing Award	2025
Smith Internal Research Grants (SIRG), $10,000, University of Maryland	2025
Polsky Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation Research Grant, $10,000, University of Chicago	2025
Institute of Entrepreneurship and Private Capital (IEPC) Research Grant, £5,400, London Business School	2025
Katherine Dusak Miller PhD Fellowship, University of Chicago	2021
Merit Bonus for Outstanding Research Professionals, University of Chicago	2017, 2018
First Class Scholarship, **Top 2%**, Wuhan University	2009

Teaching

BMGT326 Accounting Systems 2025

Instructor, Teaching evaluation: 3.8/4.0 (Undergraduate)

B30121/B30835 Accounting for Entrepreneurship: From Start Up to Exit 2022, 2023, 2024

TA for Prof. *Philip G. Berger* (MBA, Executive MBA, and Law School)

B30000 Financial Accounting 2022, 2023

TA for Prof. *Anastasia A. Zakolyukina* (MBA)

Writing Code for Research Workshop 2021

Co-instructor, three-day technical training workshop and weekly office hour for new Chicago Booth predoctoral researchers

Professional Experience

Cornerstone Research, Summer Associate 2023

University of Chicago, Booth School of Business, Research Professional 2017 – 2020

- Worked with Prof. *Anastasia A. Zakolyukina*, Prof. *Ian Gow*, and Prof. *Charles McClure*
- Textual analysis, machine learning, structural modeling, and database management

Allianz Global Investors GmbH, Analyst, Hong Kong 2015 – 2016

Bank of China (Hong Kong) Ltd., Graduate Trainee, Hong Kong 2014 – 2015

Open-Source Software

Wrds2pg: A *Python library* for automatic data migration and database management for *WRDS/PostgreSQL* [link]

- Author: Prof. *Ian Gow*, Contributor: Jingyu Zhang
- Built the terminal-based CLI for WRDS-to-PostgreSQL migration; added SAS-to-PostgreSQL data ingestion
- Packaged and published as a public PyPI package; ongoing maintenance and bug fixes

Skills

Programming: Proficient in `R, Python, Stata, SQL, and VBA`; Familiar with `SAS, Julia, C/C++, and PHP`

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent), Cantonese (fluent)

Certificate: Financial Risk Manager (FRM)

References

Rebecca N. Hann (Chair)
Dean's Professor of Accounting and KPMG Term Professor
University of Maryland
rhann@umd.edu

Philip G. Berger
Wallman Family Professor of Accounting
University of Chicago
philip.berger@chicagobooth.edu

Michael D. Kimbrough
Senior Associate Dean and Professor of Accounting
University of Maryland
mkimbrou@umd.edu

Anastasia A. Zakolyukina
Assistant Professor of Finance
Baruch College
anastasia.zakolyukina@baruch.cuny.edu

Mark Zakota
Assistant Professor of Accounting
University of Maryland
mzakota@umd.edu